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Premier League

Manchester City's life without Rodri began on a shaky note as Newcastle United held the defending champion to a 1-1 draw. A first-half strike from Josko Gvardiol was cancelled out by Anthony Gordon from the spot, meaning that City had dropped points for the second consecutive week.

With Rodri set to miss the rest of the season after suffering an Anterior Cruciate Ligament (ACL) injury, former Chelsea man Mateo Kovacic came to City's rescue the following week in a 3-2 win against Fulham. After going a goal down, the Croatian scored on either side of half-time before substitute Jeremy Doku sealed the match with a sublime strike from outside the box.

Despite the win, dropping points in successive games meant that City lost its grip on the top spot and went into the international break in second place, level on points with Arsenal and one point behind leader Liverpool.

Arne Slot has been relishing his role as Liverpool's manager as his side earned hard-fought wins on the road against Wolverhampton Wanderers and Crystal Palace. With nine victories in his first 10 games in all competitions, Slot has recorded the best start by any manager in the club's history.

However, Liverpool will be concerned about its goalkeeper

Alisson, who was substituted during the game against Crystal Palace due to a hamstring injury.

Two stoppage-time goals helped Arsenal overcome a comeback from Leicester City and win 4-2. The following week, the Gunners survived yet another scare against Southampton, with English winger Bukayo Saka providing two assists and scoring a goal to complete a 3-1 comeback win.

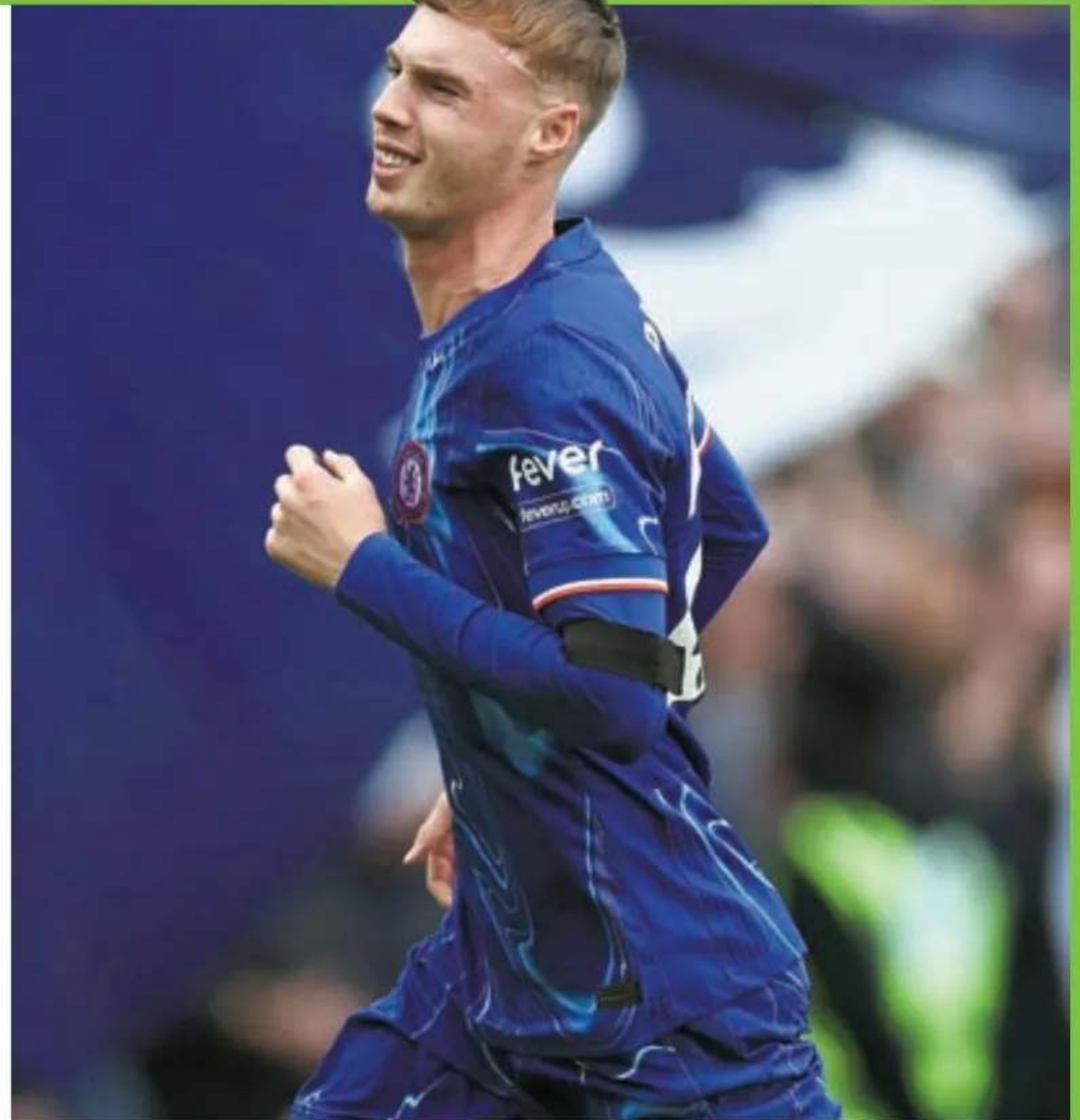
It was the Cole Palmer show for Chelsea in its 4-2 win against Brighton & Hove Albion, as the

In fine form: Cole Palmer became the first player in the Premier League era to score four goals in the first half of the match. GETTY IMAGES

22-year-old became the first player in the Premier League era to score four goals in the first half of the match. However, Enzo Maresca's men dropped points the following week after being held to a 1-1 draw against 10-man Nottingham Forest. The result meant the Blues are fourth in the table, level on 14 points with Aston Villa in fifth.

Manchester United's abysmal start to the season worsened as it was handed a 3-0

thrashing by Tottenham Hotspur. The match saw United's captain Bruno Fernandes sent off with a straight red card in the first half for a challenge on James Maddison. However, the decision was overturned by the English Football Association after a



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